

## THE FINDING

# 31

## of 50

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**brand-name searches for local businesses now show an AI Overview above the business's own listing.**

## THE METHOD

# What I searched

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I took 50 local businesses: roofers, dentists, plumbers, HVAC companies and law firms.

I searched each one by its exact business name on Google, then counted how many showed an AI Overview above the business's own listing.

## THE FINDING

# 31 of 50

## had an AI Overview above their own listing

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That's 62% of brand-name searches.

The person typed the business's name. Google answered first.

## WHAT THE OWNER SEES

**Search your own name and the first thing on the page isn't you**

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It's a summary written by Google, with your name in it and a few details about your business.

Your listing sits below it.



WHERE THE DETAILS CAME FROM

# 19 of 31

**pulled details from sources other than the business's own site**

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Directories, review sites and local listings supplied the hours, services and service area.

The business didn't write that summary. Other people's pages did.

## THE PHONE

# What it means for the phone ringing

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A customer who gets the hours, the address and the services from the summary may never scroll to your listing.

If the summary is thin or wrong, that's the first impression, and the last.

## WHAT GETS NAMED 1

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# Plain text on a readable page

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The businesses with the most complete summaries had services, areas and hours written out as plain text.

Not buried in images, sliders or PDFs.

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## Presence in third-party directories

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The summaries leaned on pages the business doesn't control.

A claimed, filled-out profile on the main directories gave the AI something accurate to quote.



## WHAT GETS NAMED 3

3

# Consistent details everywhere

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Same business name. Same address. Same phone number. Same hours.

When sources disagree, the summary gets vague or picks the wrong one.

## WHAT IT MEANS

# For a local business owner

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Your name used to lead to your listing. Now it often leads to a summary first.

What that summary says depends on what's written about you, and where.

The listing still matters. It just isn't always the first thing a customer reads.